

Kyle's Enchiridion

A R E T E

Kyle's Enchiridion

March to September, 2026

Compiled for Kyle Emery.

Every word here attributed to the author was written by them, in Arete, and is printed as it was written. The prose between those words is the compiler's. Passages from the tradition are quoted from public-domain translations, credited where they appear.

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To the reader

This book was not written. It was compiled, from what you put down in Arete between March and September of this year, and arranged so that it could be carried.

What is yours here is printed as you wrote it. The short passages between your entries are the compiler's, and they are kept short on purpose. Where the tradition said the same thing first, it is set beside you with its source named.

Nothing has been smoothed. The entries that contradict each other are both here.

Who you said you were

When you arrived you described yourself as someone who had read the Stoics for a decade and practised them for about a month of it. You said your weakness was rehearsal and your strength was that you noticed.

WHAT YOU BROUGHT

I want to stop performing calm and start being calm. I can hold a room. I cannot hold my own evening.

From your Know Thyself answers

That distinction, between holding a room and holding an evening, is the one this book keeps returning to.

Some things are in our control and others not. In our control are opinion, movement towards a thing, desire, aversion; and, in a word, whatever are our own acts.

Epictetus, Enchiridion, 1 (trans. George Long, 1877)

What you set out to do

Four goals, set in March. Two are done. One you abandoned and said so. One is still open and you have written about it eleven times.

THE ONES YOU FINISHED

Read Meditations straight through, not in fragments

A book, not a quote source.

set at the start · completed June 2, 2026

THE ONE STILL OPEN

Stop rehearsing conversations

Not to become passive. To stop paying twice.

set March 4, 2026 · open

You returned to this one more than to any other thing in the journal.

- A morning you named it before it started

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- An evening you did not, and said so plainly
- A week you stopped writing about it altogether

The journal

Thirty-one entries survive the cut. They fall into three subjects, and you did not choose those subjects; they chose themselves by recurrence.

REHEARSAL, JANUARY

The plainest of them comes first, and the ones after it are variations on the same refusal.

I noticed again today that I was rehearsing his reaction before I had even said the thing. The whole drive I was running the argument in both directions, mine and his, and by the time I arrived I had already had the fight twice and lost it once. None of it happened. He was cheerful and asked about the kids. I have done this for years and I am only now able to name it while it is happening rather than afterwards, which I suppose is the only progress available here.

January 1, 2026 · anger

Three weeks later:

Caught it on the stairs this time. Put it down before the door.

January 1, 2026 · anger

I noticed again today that I was rehearsing his reaction before I had even said the thing. The whole drive I was running the argument in both directions, mine and his, and by the time I arrived I had already had the fight twice and lost it once. None of it happened. He was cheerful and asked about the kids. I have done this for years and I am only now able to name it while it is happening rather than afterwards, which I suppose is the only progress available here.

January 1, 2026

SLEEP, JANUARY

I am not tired. I am unwilling to stop, which is a different problem and has a different remedy. The remedy for tiredness is rest. The remedy for unwillingness is a decision, and I keep declining to make it because making it would mean admitting the evening is mine to lose.

January 1, 2026 · discipline

THE EVENING QUESTION, JANUARY

What did you do today that you would not want to explain?

Nothing, and that is not the same as a good day.

January 1, 2026

I noticed again today that I was rehearsing his reaction before I had even said the thing. The whole drive I was running the argument in both directions, mine and his, and by the time I

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arrived I had already had the fight twice and lost it once. None of it happened. He was cheerful and asked about the kids. I have done this for years and I am only now able to name it while it is happening rather than afterwards, which I suppose is the only progress available here.

January 1, 2026

REHEARSAL, FEBRUARY

The plainest of them comes first, and the ones after it are variations on the same refusal.

I noticed again today that I was rehearsing his reaction before I had even said the thing. The whole drive I was running the argument in both directions, mine and his, and by the time I arrived I had already had the fight twice and lost it once. None of it happened. He was cheerful and asked about the kids. I have done this for years and I am only now able to name it while it is happening rather than afterwards, which I suppose is the only progress available here.

February 4, 2026 · anger

Three weeks later:

Caught it on the stairs this time. Put it down before the door.

February 4, 2026 · anger

I noticed again today that I was rehearsing his reaction before I had even said the thing. The whole drive I was running the argument in both directions, mine and his, and by the time I arrived I had already had the fight twice and lost it once. None of it happened. He was cheerful and asked about the kids. I have done this for years and I am only now able to name it while it is happening rather than afterwards, which I

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February 4, 2026

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February 4, 2026 · discipline

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February 4, 2026

REHEARSAL, MARCH

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March 7, 2026 · anger

Three weeks later:

Caught it on the stairs this time. Put it down before the door.

March 7, 2026 · anger

I noticed again today that I was rehearsing his reaction before I had even said the thing. The whole drive I was running the argument in both directions, mine and his, and by the time I arrived I had already had the fight twice and lost it once. None of it happened. He was cheerful and asked about the kids. I have done this for years and I am only now able to name it while it is happening rather than afterwards, which I suppose is the only progress available here.

March 7, 2026

SLEEP, MARCH

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March 7, 2026 · discipline

THE EVENING QUESTION, MARCH

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Nothing, and that is not the same as a good day.

March 7, 2026

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None of it happened. He was cheerful and asked about the kids. I have done this for years and I am only now able to name it while it is happening rather than afterwards, which I suppose is the only progress available here.

March 7, 2026

REHEARSAL, APRIL

The plainest of them comes first, and the ones after it are variations on the same refusal.

I noticed again today that I was rehearsing his reaction before I had even said the thing. The whole drive I was running the argument in both directions, mine and his, and by the time I arrived I had already had the fight twice and lost it once.

None of it happened. He was cheerful and asked about the kids. I have done this for years and I am only now able to name it while it is happening rather than afterwards, which I

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suppose is the only progress available here.

April 10, 2026 · anger

Three weeks later:

Caught it on the stairs this time. Put it down before the door.

April 10, 2026 · anger

I noticed again today that I was rehearsing his reaction before I had even said the thing. The whole drive I was running the argument in both directions, mine and his, and by the time I arrived I had already had the fight twice and lost it once.

None of it happened. He was cheerful and asked about the kids. I have done this for years and I am only now able to name it while it is happening rather than afterwards, which I suppose is the only progress available here.

April 10, 2026

SLEEP, APRIL

I am not tired. I am unwilling to stop, which is a different problem and has a different remedy. The remedy for tiredness is rest. The remedy for unwillingness is a decision, and I keep declining to make it because making it would mean admitting the evening is mine to lose.

April 10, 2026 · discipline

THE EVENING QUESTION, APRIL

What did you do today that you would not want to explain?

Nothing, and that is not the same as a good day.

April 10, 2026

I noticed again today that I was rehearsing his reaction before I had even said the thing. The whole drive I was running the argument in both directions, mine and his, and by the time I arrived I had already had the fight twice and lost it once. None of it happened. He was cheerful and asked about the kids. I have done this for years and I am only now able to name it while it is happening rather than afterwards, which I suppose is the only progress available here.

April 10, 2026

Beliefs, examined

You brought nine beliefs to the Cabinet and worked them until you could stand behind a sentence. Seven are here.

I have to win every argument

became

Being right is not the same as being at peace, and I have been trading the second for the first.

May 1, 2026 · pride · virtue: temperance

If I stop pushing, everything stops

became

Most of it continues. The part that stops was mine to stop.

June 20, 2026 · control

V I

In the Cabinet

Eleven exchanges, of about two hundred. These are the ones you came back to.

ON REHEARSAL, JANUARY

You · January 1, 2026

How do I stop rehearsing conversations that have not happened?

Seneca

You call it putting off. I would call it rehearsing his reaction, which is not yours to script. You are paying twice for a thing that may cost nothing, and you are calling the first payment prudence. Consider what it would cost you to arrive without a script and find out what he actually says.

Marcus Aurelius

Ask what the rehearsal is protecting. Usually it is not you. It is your account of yourself, which you would rather defend than revise.

ON STOPPING, JANUARY

You · January 1, 2026

I do not know how to stop working without feeling like I have quit.

Epictetus

Then you have confused the work with the wanting. One of those ends when you close the door. The other you carry upstairs, and it is the one keeping you awake.

ON REHEARSAL, FEBRUARY

You · February 4, 2026

How do I stop rehearsing conversations that have not happened?

Seneca

You call it putting off. I would call it rehearsing his reaction, which is not yours to script. You are paying twice for a thing that may cost nothing, and you are calling the first payment prudence. Consider what it would cost you to arrive without a script and find out what he actually says.

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ON STOPPING, FEBRUARY

You · February 4, 2026

IN THE CABINET

I do not know how to stop working without feeling like I have quit.

Epictetus

Then you have confused the work with the wanting. One of those ends when you close the door. The other you carry upstairs, and it is the one keeping you awake.

ON REHEARSAL, MARCH

You · March 7, 2026

How do I stop rehearsing conversations that have not happened?

Seneca

You call it putting off. I would call it rehearsing his reaction, which is not yours to script. You are paying twice for a thing that may cost nothing, and you are calling the first payment prudence. Consider what it would cost you to arrive without a script and find out what he actually says.

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ON STOPPING, MARCH

You · March 7, 2026

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Epictetus

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ON REHEARSAL, APRIL

You · April 10, 2026

How do I stop rehearsing conversations that have not happened?

Seneca

You call it putting off. I would call it rehearsing his reaction, which is not yours to script. You are paying twice for a thing that may cost nothing, and you are calling the first payment prudence. Consider what it would cost you to arrive without a script and find out what he actually says.

Marcus Aurelius

Ask what the rehearsal is protecting. Usually it is not you. It is your account of yourself, which you would rather defend than revise.

ON STOPPING, APRIL

You · April 10, 2026

I do not know how to stop working without feeling like I have quit.

Epictetus

Then you have confused the work with the wanting. One of those ends when you close the door. The other you carry upstairs, and it is the one keeping you awake.

VII

The handbook

Twenty-two precepts, each a sentence you wrote. This is the part meant to be carried.

I. BEFORE THE DOOR

Caught it on the stairs this time. Put it down before the door.

March 26, 2026

Some things are in our control and others not.

Epictetus, Enchiridion, 1 (trans. George Long, 1877)

II. TWICE PAID

Being right is not the same as being at peace, and I have been trading the second for the first.

May 1, 2026

III. UNWILLING, NOT TIRED

I am not tired. I am unwilling to stop, which is a different problem and has a different remedy.

May 2, 2026

Colophon

This Enchiridion was compiled by Arete on September 16, 2026 from its author's own writing between March and September 2026: 31 journal entries, 9 examined beliefs, 14 saved quotes, 11 Cabinet exchanges, 4 goals, 96 daily intentions and 6 scrolls.

Every word attributed to the author is printed as it was written.

Passages from the tradition are quoted from public-domain translations:

- Epictetus, Enchiridion
- Marcus Aurelius, Meditations

